Churchill's War Rooms, tied into an overarching theme of identity. We did something similar in the Tower of London, with a military speaker.

The underground bunker, beneath Westminster, from which the War Cabinet operated, was evocative, though my speech was hardly Churchillian. I had thought long and hard about its tone and content. As in Jamaica, I thought honesty the best policy. I spoke passionately about my competitiveness, of not letting down those close to me. Sure, we could inspire others. But first we had to look to each other.

That's the three-card trick of managing a dressing room. It must be big enough to accommodate the larger characters, and small enough to breed the intimacy that enables you to show how much you care. Differences should be celebrated, because no successful team contains identical personalities. That's the theory, anyway …

Reality tends to set ambushes. We were number one in the world, hoping to push on, and suddenly lost all three Tests in the winter series against Pakistan, who were ranked fifth in the world. Chasing 145 to win the second Test at Abu Dhabi, we lost all ten wickets for fifty-one runs on the way to being bowled out for 72. It was a chastening setback; the subsequent series in Sri Lanka was drawn, and we still had to prove our mettle in Asian conditions.

Fault lines that existed, largely unnoticed and completely unprotected, opened during the main summer series, against South Africa. KP's exclusion from Andrew Strauss's 100th Test, at Lord's, mirrored his idiosyncrasies and inconsistencies, and raised fundamental issues of trust.

Perversely, we were engulfed in that particular controversy after one of KP's most distinctive innings, 149 in the drawn second Test at Headingley. That was a work of genius. His individualism in playing with the nerve and aggression of a baseball slugger was extraordinary and, in hindsight, revealing, since it seemed to be a release of frustration.

He hinted at retirement in an interview, and then recommitted to the team. The tone was strange, but I understood what he meant when he famously observed, 'It's not easy being me in that dressing room.' He is a man of great gifts, compelling passions, soaring highs and puzzling lows. A psychologist will tell you that anyone with such a strong sense of self is inclined to introspection and liable to view the world with a narrow focus.

His suspension was inevitable, once an investigation was launched into his sending of what were described as 'provocative' messages to South